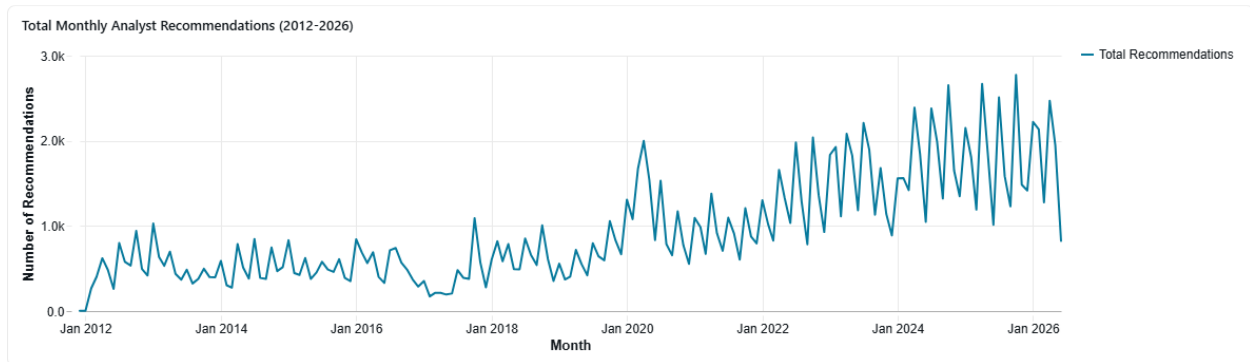


Monthly Trends in Analyst Recommendations

Analyst recommendation activity has **grown significantly over time**, with total monthly recommendations increasing from around 400-800 in 2012 to peaks of over 2,000 in recent years (2022-2025). The data shows a dramatic surge in March 2020, coinciding with COVID-19 market volatility, followed by sustained higher activity levels.



Key Findings

Sustained Growth in Activity:

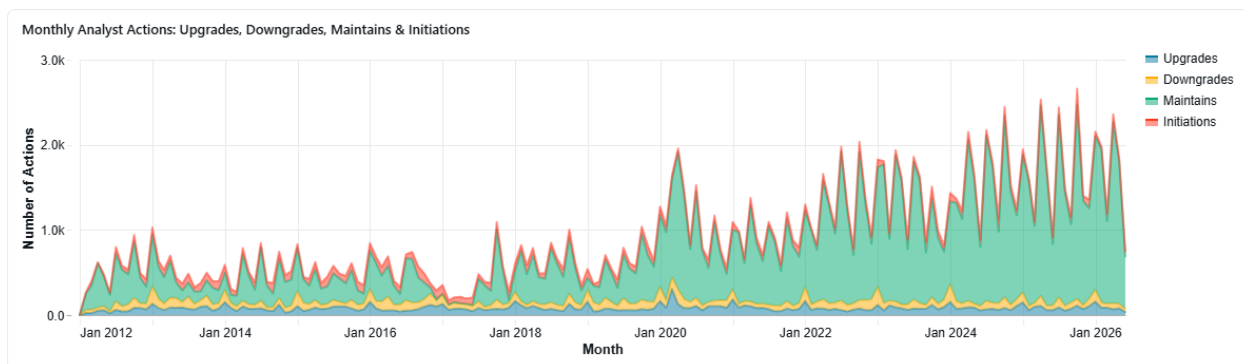
Annual recommendations grew from 5,803 in 2012 to a peak of 21,703 in 2025 — nearly a **4x increase**. The most dramatic growth occurred between 2019 (7,610 recommendations) and 2020 (13,909 recommendations), an 83% year-over-year increase driven by pandemic-related market volatility.

March 2020 Spike:

The most notable spike occurred in March 2020, with a dramatic surge in all action types as analysts responded to the COVID-19 market crash. This period saw heightened activity across upgrades, downgrades, and maintains as firms reassessed their positions.

"Maintains" Dominate:

Across all periods, "Maintain" actions consistently represent the largest share of recommendations, often comprising 50-70% of monthly activity. This reflects analysts' tendency to reaffirm existing ratings more frequently than changing them. Upgrades and downgrades typically occur in more balanced proportions, though downgrades spiked during market downturns (2013, 2016, 2020).



Declining Firm Participation:

Despite increasing recommendation volume, the number of unique firms issuing ratings has declined from 147 in 2012 to 79 in 2026 (partial year), suggesting industry consolidation. However, stock coverage has expanded from 390 to 495 unique stocks.

2026 Partial Year Data:

The 2026 data (through mid-June) shows 10,876 recommendations, which is on pace for another high-volume year if the trend continues through year-end.

Annual Summary of Analyst Recommendations (2012-2026)

Year	Total Recommendations	Upgrades	Downgrades	Unique Stocks	Unique Firms
2012-01-01 12:00 AM	5,803	573	642	390	147
2013-01-01 12:00 AM	6,181	1,020	1,208	400	158
2014-01-01 12:00 AM	6,195	921	776	401	148
2015-01-01 12:00 AM	6,034	958	913	411	142
2016-01-01 12:00 AM	6,688	951	1,209	418	131
2017-01-01 12:00 AM	4,544	899	799	423	112
2018-01-01 12:00 AM	7,801	1,068	786	429	106
2019-01-01 12:00 AM	7,610	845	1,140	443	113